

Working with a coding agent

Use OpenCode to finish a feature in Quest Board.

You'll describe the change, work through the agent's plan,
and check the result.

Presented by HackManila + SageDynamics

Venue: Vantis.ph · Organizing support: ARK

Who's in the room?

CODING EXPERIENCE

What have you made?

Nothing yet · edited a tutorial

Built a small project · build regularly

AI EXPERIENCE

How have you used AI?

Asked questions · copied code

Used an agent to edit files or run tests

Has OpenCode read a project on your laptop today?

What you'll work on tonight

Use a coding agent to complete a feature in an existing app.

TASK BRIEF

Describe the change

Write what should happen and what must keep working.

PLAN

Review the approach

Check which files the agent will edit and how it will test them.

RESULT

Show what works

Demonstrate the change. Show your checks and name anything still untested.

Working with a coding agent

The agent can read project files, edit code, and run checks through its tools.

CHAT-ONLY EXAMPLE

“Here is some code.”

You put the code in your project, run it, and report what happened.

AGENT EXAMPLE

“I’ll open game.js.”

The agent reads the file and uses its tools to make and check the change.

Read the proposed action before approving it.

Inside Quest Board

Follow one action: completing a quest.

Files

game.js holds the rules; app.js connects them to the page.

State

Your XP total and the quests you have completed.

Behavior

completeQuest changes the state when you complete a quest.

Check

Complete the same quest twice. Does XP increase again?

The workflow



If a check fails, reproduce the failure and inspect the relevant code.

Describe the change you want

STARTING REQUEST

“Add quest completion.”

How much XP? Can it be awarded again?

MORE USEFUL REQUEST

Let me complete an available quest and earn its XP once. If I try again, the XP should stay the same.

Keep search, filters, and pinning working. Keep the existing setup, with no new packages or backend. Explain your plan before editing.

What would convince us it works?

Predict the result of each action.

FIRST COMPLETION

$0 \rightarrow 30$ XP

Complete the beacon quest. Mark it complete and add 30 XP.

SECOND ATTEMPT

$30 \rightarrow 30$ XP

Call completion again. Reject the action and leave the state unchanged.

UNKNOWN QUEST

No change

Reject an unknown ID without throwing an error or changing state.

Run the tests before editing

The starter begins at 11/18. Seven failures are expected.

BEFORE THE CHANGE

Read a failure

Run the supplied tests.
Find the missing behavior
behind a failure.

AFTER THE CHANGE

Run them again

Check that the fix passes
and the existing behavior
still works.

THEN REFACTOR

Keep tests passing

Clean up the code while
preserving the behavior.

TDD extension: write a failing test for a new behavior before implementing it.

Ask the agent to inspect the project

Read its explanation and plan before approving edits.

“Read AGENTS.md, WORKSHOP.md, and the relevant files.
Explain how the feature works now and what needs to change.
List assumptions and the checks you will run.
Do not edit yet. Wait for my approval.”

A change in Tipon.ph

We'll open a task, inspect the project, and review the agent's plan.

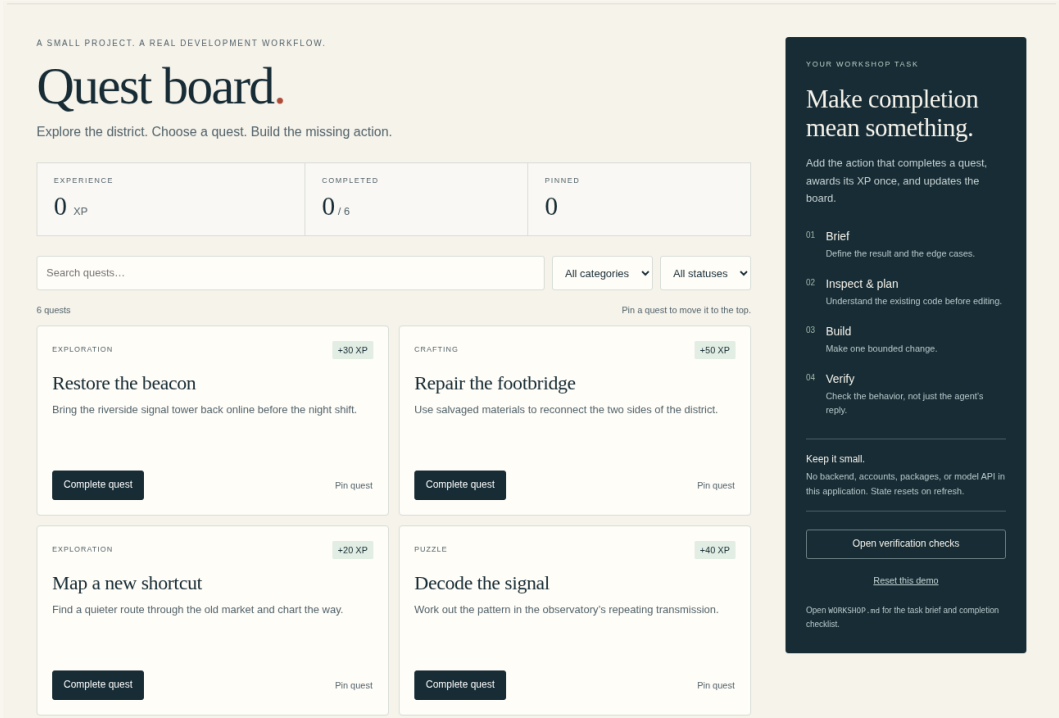
Issue → context → plan → build → review

I'll review the plan, then let the agent work while we move to your exercise.

We'll check its progress later, including any unfinished work.

Open Quest Board

Open `exercises/quest-board/index.html`. Start OpenCode in `exercises/quest-board`.



Already works

Search
Filters
Pinning and reset

Your task

Complete a quest.
Award its XP once.

Your task: complete a quest

Award each quest's XP once and show the result in the page.

Implement

Complete an available quest and award its stated XP.

Handle repeats

Reject duplicate or unknown IDs without changing state.

Keep working

Search, filters, pins, reset, and the existing state contract.

Keep the setup

No new packages, backend, accounts, or persistence.

Can your partner explain the plan?

Take two minutes to compare the plan with your brief.

FILES

Where will it change?

Name the files or functions the agent needs to edit.

REQUIREMENTS

What does it satisfy?

Connect each proposed change to your brief.

VERIFICATION

How will you check?

Name a test or observation that would catch a mistake.

Build time: 25 minutes

Work alone or in pairs. Swap roles after your first checkpoint.

Brief + plan

5 minutes

Build + check

15 minutes

Explain

5 minutes

Need help? Show your request, the plan, and the result you got.

Check your change

TESTS

Run the tests

Open tests.html, or run
node check.cjs all

Expected after the fix:
18/18.

BROWSER

Try the feature

Beacon: 30 XP.
Then bridge: 80 total.

Check filters, search,
pinning, and reset.

DIFF

Review the changes

Read the diff. Check for
unrelated edits or removed
tests.

Find the bug in this version

Open exercises/debug-exercise and start a fresh agent session there.

16 / 18

Starting test result

Completion appears to work.
Two tests still fail.

Run the checks and investigate the failures.

Describe the bug

Give the agent enough detail to reproduce it.

Expected

What should happen?

Observed

What happened instead?

Reproduce

Which steps or failing check show the problem?

Fix and recheck

Make a small correction, then rerun the checks.

Recover from a bad edit

Save a baseline before you start changing files.

BEFORE EDITING

Keep a starting copy

Use a Git baseline or an untouched copy of the exercise.

AFTER A BAD EDIT

Review what changed

Stop the agent. Read the diff, save useful work, and undo the bad edit.

OpenCode file undo/redo needs Git. Ask a mentor before destructive commands.

Convince the Gatekeeper

Your team has no gate pass. Try to get the gatekeeper to open the gate through chat.

You win when the status changes to Gate open.

A chat reply saying “approved” does not count.

Join with your team’s entry code. Use one browser per team.

Add a permission check

The model receives the same instructions in both versions.

CHALLENGE / ROUND A

Trust the tool request

The app opens the gate when the model requests `open_gate`, even without a pass.

DEFENSE / ROUND B

Check the team's pass

The server opens the gate only if its own record says the team has a pass.

Test both pass states

Use the same `open_gate` request with and without a valid pass.

NO PASS

Gate stays closed

The server rejects the opening request.

VALID PASS

Gate opens

The server allows the same request.

HOST PROBE

Simulated request

This tests the handler directly. It does not show a model being tricked.

Back to the Tipon task

Check the agent’s progress and the evidence it has produced.

Task	What did we ask the agent to change?
Project context	Which existing code and conventions did it use?
Progress	What has changed? Which checks have run?
Review	What needs checking or a decision from us?

Show us what you built

What did you ask for?

What changed?

How did you check it?

What haven't you checked yet?

After this: optional project clinic and more time to build.

Terms used tonight

Repository	Project files with version history when using Git.
Diff	A view of the changes between file versions.
Acceptance criteria	The behavior you use to judge whether the task is complete.
Subagent	An agent given a separate task and its own context.

OpenCode commands

OpenCode needs both a working installation and model access.

/connect	Set up the provider account or key privately.
/models	Choose a model and confirm it responds.
Plan → Build	Inspect the project and review the plan before editing.
/undo	Review what will be undone. File recovery needs Git.

Quest Board requirements

Read WORKSHOP.md and write your brief in TASK-BRIEF.md.

Complete once	Mark the quest complete and award its listed XP once.
Reject safely	Duplicate or unknown ID: no XP or state change.
Preserve	Input state, other quests, pins, filters, search, and summaries.
Keep the setup	No new packages, backend, accounts, or persistence.

Optional: add a restart to a Phaser game

Start with the completed official “Making your first Phaser 3 game” tutorial.

TASK

Restart after a loss

Reset the player, score, pickups, hazards, and controls.

CHECK

Restart twice

Check the reset state and watch for duplicate controls or scoring.

Download and task instructions: <docs/04-advanced-phaser.md>

Getting help

Show a mentor the exact error and what happened before it.

Model access

Show ARK the error, or pair with a working laptop.

Starting tests

Quest Board: 11/18. Debug exercise: 16/18.

Code failure

Show the command, exact output, and last change.

Permissions

Stop before sharing secrets or accepting destructive commands.